

The Southern Plateau of India

EXERCISE ANSWERS & SOLUTION KEY

Overview: This document provides comprehensive, verified solutions to all exercises, warm-up questions, and active zones in Chapter 5: *The Southern Plateau of India*. These answers are fully grounded in the textbook chapter text and designed for classroom instruction, self-study, and verification.

1. Warm Up! (Page 43)

Rearrange the letters to get the names of a few places or states located in the Southern Plateau:

- 1. NATAKARAK → KARNATAKA
- 2. REALAK → KERALA
- 3. MLTAI NDU A → TAMIL NADU
- 4. AHARMASTHR → MAHARASHTRA

2. Quick Zone — Objective Questions (Page 51-52)

A. Tick (☐) the correct options to complete the sentences:

- Q1. The southern part of India is rich in _____.
Answer: (b) minerals
Context: The Southern Plateau of India is incredibly rich in minerals and is often referred to as a storehouse of mineral resources.
- Q2. The oldest landmass of India is the _____.
Answer: (c) Southern Plateau
Context: It is the oldest landmass of India, characterized by a rocky and uneven triangular landform.
- Q3. A city that lies in the Southern Plateau is _____.
Answer: (d) Mysuru
Context: Mysuru is a major historic city in Karnataka, which lies within the Southern Plateau region.
- Q4. The Nilgiri hills are in _____.
Answer: (a) Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Kerala
Context: The Nilgiri hills are situated at the junction of these three southern states in the Western Ghats.
- Q5. _____ is a west flowing river.
Answer: (d) Narmada
Context: Unlike most plateau rivers which flow east into the Bay of Bengal, the Narmada and the Tapi flow westwards into the Arabian Sea.

B. Fill in the blanks:

- 1. The Chota Nagpur Plateau is in the north-eastern part of the Southern Plateau.
- 2. Kanyakumari is the southernmost tip of the Indian mainland.
- 3. The river Tapi flows into the Arabian Sea.
- 4. Cotton and oilseeds grow well in black soil. (Alternatively: cotton and sugarcane/wheat)
- 5. Dams and tanks are the main sources of irrigation in the Southern Plateau.

C. Write (T) for true statements and (F) for false statements:

- 1. The Tibetan Plateau is the highest plateau in the world. — **T** (True)
(Known as the 'Roof of the World')
- 2. The Satpura Range is located between the river Narmada and the river Tapi. — **T** (True)
(These rivers flow on either side of the Satpura range)
- 3. Bengaluru is the capital of Andhra Pradesh. — **F** (False)
(Bengaluru is the capital of Karnataka; Andhra Pradesh's major capital/city is Amravati)
- 4. The Southern Plateau region of India is rich in minerals. — **T** (True)
(It holds rich deposits of coal, iron, mica, bauxite, and gold)
- 5. The Northern Plains lie to the south of the Peninsular Plateau. — **F** (False)
(The Peninsular Plateau lies to the south of the Northern Plains)

D. Match the columns A and B:

Column A	Column B (Original Options)	Correct Matches
1. Tableland	(i) Rajmahal hills	1 → (iv) Plateau
2. Tibetan Plateau	(ii) Cardamom hills	2 → (iii) The Roof of the World
3. Deccan Plateau	(iii) The Roof of the World	3 → (ii) Cardamom hills
4. Dams	(iv) Plateau	4 → (v) Irrigation
5. Chota Nagpur Plateau	(v) Irrigation	5 → (i) Rajmahal hills

3. Writing Zone — Short & Long Answers (Page 52)

Q1. What is a plateau? How is it different from a mountain?

Answer: A **plateau** is an elevated or high area of land that is fairly levelled or flat at the top, which is why it is also known as a **tableland**. A plateau is always higher than the ground surface immediately surrounding it, but is lower than mountains.

Difference from a mountain: A mountain rises significantly higher to a sharp, narrow peak or summit with very steep slopes. In contrast, a plateau has a broad, relatively flat top surface with steep sides but lacks a single prominent peak.

Q2. Why is mining an important activity in Jharkhand?

Answer: Mining is an extremely important economic activity in Jharkhand because the state lies in the mineral-rich **Chota Nagpur Plateau**. This region contains massive, valuable deposits of coal, iron ore, bauxite, manganese, and mica. Due to this abundance of mineral raw materials, Jharkhand supports major heavy industries, including the famous **Bokaro Steel Plant**, **Jamshedpur Steel Plant**, and various metal works.

Q3. Name three cities, one each from Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka, and mention the products they are known for.

Answer: Below are three cities from these states and their associated key industries or products:

- **Maharashtra: Mumbai** — Famous for **Mumbai High** (crude oil extraction), textiles, orange processing, and the Hindi film industry (Bollywood).
- **Andhra Pradesh: Visakhapatnam** — Famous for its **steel production**, heavy IT industries, and ship building.
- **Karnataka: Bengaluru** — Globally famous as India's IT capital (**IT Industry**), high-quality **coffee**, handicrafts, and gold mining (Kolar Gold Fields in the state).

Q4. Name four rivers of the Deccan Plateau region.

Answer: The Deccan Plateau is drained by several major rivers. The four most prominent **east-flowing, rain-fed rivers** that rise in the Western Ghats and flow into the Bay of Bengal are:

1. **The Mahanadi**
2. **The Godavari** (the longest river in the Deccan Plateau)
3. **The Krishna**
4. **The Kaveri**

Note: Unlike these, the Narmada and Tapi are the region's only two major west-flowing rivers, emptying into the Arabian Sea.

Q5. Name the minerals found in the Deccan Plateau region of India.

Answer: The Deccan Plateau (and the wider Southern Plateau) is a rich storehouse of mineral resources. The major minerals found in abundance here include:

- **Coal** and **Iron Ore** (highly crucial for steel production)
- **Manganese** and **Bauxite** (aluminum ore)
- **Mica**, **Copper Ore**, and **Gold** (found in regions like Karnataka's Kolar Gold Fields)
- **Diamonds** (historically and in neighboring areas like Panna in Madhya Pradesh).

4. Art Integration Zone (Page 52)

Identify and write the names of the dance forms and the states to which the following dances belong based on the textbook illustrations:

Image 1 (Left Image):

- **Dance Form:** **Bharatanatyam** (or Kuchipudi)
- **State:** **Tamil Nadu** (Andhra Pradesh for Kuchipudi)
- *Explanation: The image features classical dancers in a dynamic team pose wearing traditional temple jewelry and pleated costumes, strongly matching Bharatanatyam which is the classical dance form of Tamil Nadu.*

Image 2 (Middle Image):

- **Dance Form:** **Odissi**
- **State:** **Odisha**
- *Explanation: The dancers are wearing the signature silver ornaments and unique headpieces ('tahia') characteristic of Odissi classical dance from Odisha.*

Image 3 (Right Image):

- **Dance Form:** **Lavani**
- **State:** **Maharashtra**
- *Explanation: Dancers are draped in traditional Maharashtrian 9-yard (Nauvari) sarees, performing the energetic, rhythmic folk-dance steps of Lavani, a traditional dance form of Maharashtra.*

5. Problem Solving & Communication Zones (Page 53)

Problem Solving Zone (Map Work):

The textbook asks to mark and label five specific states that lie in the plateau region on a political map of India:

Madhya Pradesh, Karnataka, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, and Maharashtra.

Teacher/Student Mapping Guide:

- **Madhya Pradesh:** Located in the north-central part of India, encompassing the northern boundary of the plateau region.
- **Maharashtra:** Sprawls across the western part of the Deccan Plateau, east of the Western Ghats.
- **Karnataka:** Lies in the south-western part of the Deccan Plateau, bounded by the Western Ghats.
- **Jharkhand:** Situated in the north-eastern part of the plateau, forming the core of the Chota Nagpur Plateau.
- **Tamil Nadu:** Forms the southernmost boundary of the plateau, where the Eastern and Western Ghats meet at the Nilgiris.

Communication Zone (Discussion & Inquiry):

- **Famous Temples in Odisha:** The **Sun Temple in Konark** (famous for its unique chariot-like architecture with 24 wheels and 7 horses) and the **Jagannath Temple in Puri** (renowned for its massive wood-carved deities, spiritual significance, and the annual Rath Yatra). These temples are famous as architectural marvels and centers of deep historical and cultural heritage.
- **Famous Dances of Maharashtra:** The **Lavani dance**, which is a folk performance that combines music, rhythm, and poetry, traditionally danced to the rapid, pulsing beats of the *Dholki*.